

Password Safety Guide

Passwords help protect your personal information and online accounts. Strong passwords make it more difficult for scammers to access critical confidential information. Therefore, following good password habits is one of the easiest ways to reduce your risk of being scammed.

What Makes a Good Password?

A good password should:

- Be at least 12 characters long
- Include a combination of uppercase letters, lowercase letters, numbers, and symbols
- Be unique for each account
- Be difficult for others to guess

Examples

Weak Password

Password123

Strong Password

purple?RIver%Map1295

(Do not use this exact password for anything. It is only an example.)

Avoid Common Password Mistakes

Avoid using these in your passwords:

- Your Name
- Birthdays
- Phone Numbers
- Name of relatives or pets
- Simple words like “password” or “hello”
- The same password from another account

If a scammer knows the password to one account, they might try to use that same password on all your other accounts.

Remember to never share your passwords by phone, email, or text message. It is also important to not write down your passwords where others can easily find them. If you write your passwords down, keep it in a secure place like a safe and be sure to shred any old files with passwords. Password managers can also help securely store your passwords.